



The 5-Minute Gratitude Reset

A Simple Daily Practice That Changes Everything

A free guide from Janis at ChooseWow

Why This Guide Exists

After 8 countries, building companies, and learning what actually creates lasting change, I discovered the most powerful daily practice isn't complex. It's remarkably simple.

This isn't about forcing positivity or ignoring life's challenges. It's about **training your brain to notice what's already working**—and how that small shift compounds into something bigger.

The 5-Minute Reset (Your Daily Practice)

1

Ground Yourself

- Three deep breaths
- Feel your feet on the floor
- Notice: "I am here, right now"

2

What Worked Today?

Write one thing that went well today. Could be:

A conversation that energized you • A moment of unexpected beauty • A problem you solved • Someone who showed you kindness

Don't filter for "big" things. Small counts.

3

Who Made a Difference?

Name one person who positively impacted your day. Write their name and what they did.

Tomorrow, consider telling them.

4

What Did You Learn?

One insight, realization, or "aha" moment from today. Could be about yourself, others, life, or work.

Learning happens everywhere. Notice it.

5

Tomorrow's Intention

One thing you want to approach with presence tomorrow. Not a to-do. An intention.

"Listen more deeply in conversations" • "Notice three beautiful things" • "Be patient with myself during the morning rush"

Your brain needs repetition, not perfection.

Why 5 Minutes Works

- 5 minutes is sustainable (even on terrible days)
- Consistency beats intensity
- Small practices compound into big shifts
- You build the muscle gradually

Research shows gratitude practices rewire neural pathways within 2–3 weeks of consistent practice. But only if you actually do them.

The Science Behind It

When you consistently notice positive elements in your day:

- Your RAS (Reticular Activating System) begins scanning for more positive experiences

- Stress hormones decrease
- Sleep quality improves
- Relationships get stronger (you notice good in others)
- Decision-making becomes clearer

Getting Started

Week 1: Just do the practice. Don't judge it.

Week 2: Notice what you're noticing. Are you seeing things differently?

Week 3: Consider sharing appreciations with people from "Minute 3."

Week 4: Reflect on what's shifted. Most people report sleeping better, feeling less reactive, and finding more genuine moments of contentment.

When It Gets Hard

Some days you'll think: "Nothing good happened today."

That's exactly when the practice matters most.

Start smaller:

"I had clean water to drink" • "My body carried me through the day" • "Someone smiled at me" • "I learned something new (even if it was difficult)"

The goal isn't toxic positivity. It's honest acknowledgment of what's actually present, alongside whatever challenges you're facing.

Beyond 5 Minutes

This practice is your foundation. As it becomes natural, you might find yourself:

- Noticing beauty more automatically
- Feeling more connected to people
- Recovering from stress faster
- Making decisions from clarity instead of reaction

And when you're ready to go deeper into intentional living practices, that's where more structured approaches can help.

Your Next Step

Print this guide. Keep it visible for the first week.

Start tonight or tomorrow morning—whichever feels right.

Most importantly: **be kind to yourself as you build this habit.** Progress over perfection, always.

Ready for a more structured approach to gratitude and intentional living?

Learn about my 90-day WowDay Journal at wowday.life

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